THE MICHAEL JORDAN ARCHIVE

# ARTIFACT ATTRIBUTION FRAMEWORK

A FIVE-PARAMETER EVIDENTIARY STANDARD FOR HISTORICAL SPORTS ARTIFACTS

## ATTRIBUTION CLASSIFICATIONS

| TIER | CLASSIFICATION | VISUAL DESIGNATION | DEFINITION |
|---|---|---|---|
| TIER A | DEFINITIVE ATTRIBUTION | BLACK & GOLD | All five evidentiary parameters independently support the conclusive attribution with no material conflicting evidence observed. |
| TIER B | STRONG ATTRIBUTION | BLACK & SILVER | Conclusive evidentiary support. One parameter may be limited, but no material conflicting evidence exists. |
| TIER C | SUPPORTED ATTRIBUTION<br>Probable Photo Match | BLACK & BRONZE | Multiple evidentiary indicators support the proposed photographic identification, though limitations in image clarity, visibility, or other evidentiary parameters prevent a conclusive determination. |
| TIER I | INCONCLUSIVE ATTRIBUTION | BLACK & OXIDIZED RED | The available evidence is insufficient to support or exclude the proposed attribution with reasonable confidence. |

Tier A and Tier B both represent conclusive photo-match determinations.
Tier A meets all five evidentiary parameters. Tier B has strong overall evidentiary support despite one documented limitation that does not materially weaken the photographic identification.

## PARAMETER STATUS KEY

**PRESENT**
The evidentiary parameter conclusively supports the attribution with no material limitations observed.

**LIMITED**
The parameter partially supports the attribution but is limited by factors such as image quality, visibility, incomplete documentation, or restricted comparative detail.

**NOT PRESENT**
The parameter is unsupported, inconclusive, or materially conflicts with proposed attribution.

## THE FIVE EVIDENTIARY PARAMETERS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | STRUCTURAL ALIGNMENT | The ovarall construction, shape, proportional layout, panel configuration, seam positioning, and physical structure align consistently with the reference imagery across observable areas. |
| 2 | UNIQUE CHARACTERISTICS | Distinct non-replicable identifiers are visible and align conclusively, including wear patterns, repairs, defects, material irregularities, scuffs, creasing markings, or other one-of-one characteristics. |
| 3 | IMAGE CLARITY & VISIBILITY | The quality of the reference imagery is sufficient to reliably evaluate the relevant areas of comparison, including resolution, lighting, angle, visibility, cropping, and obstruction. |
| 4 | CHRONOLOGICAL/ MANUFACTURING CONSISTENCY | The artifact is consistent with the known production period, manufacturing characteristics, materials, construction methods, labeling, and documented usage window. |
| 5 | PROVENANCE/ HISTORICAL CONSISTENCY | The documented history of the artifact supports the attribution through ownership history, acquistion records, transfer history, historical documentation, and overall historical plausibility. |

## TIER REQUIREMENTS

| | |
|---|---|
| TIER A | All five evidentiary parameters must be classified as Present. No material conflicting evidence may exist. |
| TIER B | Four parameters must be classified as Present. One parameter may be classified as Limited. |
| TIER C | Multiple parameters support attribution, though one or more areas remain substantially limited or incomplete. |
| TIER I | The available evidence is insufficient to reach a reliable attribution conclusion. |

## FRAMEWORK NOTES

- The framework is applied through documented research, comparative analysis, and professional judgment.
- A Tier A classification represents complete evidentiary convergence across all five parameters.
- A limited parameter prevents Tier A classification.
- Conflicting evidence within any parameter may reduce or exclude attribution classification.
- Not all artifacts will qualify for Tier A attribution.
- The framework is intended to provide transparency, consistency, and evidentiary structure to historical artifact attribution.

## EXAMPLE ATTRIBUTION SUMMARY

| PARAMETER | STATUS |
|---|---|
| 1. Structural Alignment | Present |
| 2. Unoque Characteristics | Present |
| 3. Image Clarity & Visibility | Present |
| 4. Chronological / Manufactering Consistency | Present |
| 5. Provenance / Historical Consistency | Present |

## REPORT DETERMINATIONS

TIER A | DEFINITIVE ATTRIBUTION
**Conclusive Photo Match**

TIER B | STRONG ATTRIBUTION
**Conclusive Photo Match**

TIER C | SUPPORTED ATTRIBUTION
**Probable Photo Match**

BUILD ON EVIDENCE. DRIVEN BY INTEGRITY. PRESERVING HISTORY.